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Workforce Engagement Management (WEM) covers the software that schedules, measures, coaches and assists contact-centre staff, and increasingly the AI agents working beside them.

This week's main developments

- Salesforce said its own contact-centre software would go on sale in Europe on 16 October, including the UK. Its global price page now lists £100 or €125 per user a month.
- Decagon has hired a bank to test buyer interest, Business Insider reports. The only named suitor, ServiceNow, says it has "no interest or intention" of buying Decagon.
- The personal-agent standard led by Sierra and Meta became a public draft on GitHub. Lorikeet switched it on; Zendesk and Parloa announced their own entry points for personal agents.
- xAI says Starlink's call centres answer 20,000 calls a day with its voice AI, and about 70% are resolved with no human.
- A Fin page that gave a 67% average resolution rate last week now says 76% "across all customers". The page date did not change.
- As far as we can tell, no tracked vendor yet changes live schedules by itself when demand shifts. Lorikeet's own table says that feature was "not live at launch".

Salesforce brings its contact centre to Europe

- Salesforce said on 13 October that its own contact centre would go live on 16 October in "30+ European countries including the UK", with Australia and New Zealand to follow in November.
- Its global price page now lists the base product at $125, €125 or £100 per user a month. The version with workforce engagement management costs $250, €250 or £200.
- The workforce management add-on now has a price in every listed currency, including Australian dollars and yen. It costs $50 or £40 per user a month.
- The UK and EU versions of the price page still showed no local prices on 18 October.
- Salesforce plans that from November its Casey agent will rank contact reasons, then build and test fixes. Salesforce says: "A human approves every change."
- **Our view:** Salesforce now competes for contact-centre seats in Europe. Its price list keeps two units: human staff pay per seat, while its customer-facing AI is billed on credits.
- **Watch:** local prices on the UK and EU pages, and the November launches in Australia and New Zealand.

Decagon tests a sale

- Business Insider reported on 13 October that Decagon hired a bank to evaluate acquisition interest. It says Decagon held early talks with ServiceNow and others. The report is unconfirmed.

- ServiceNow's president, Amit Zavery, told PYMNTS: "ServiceNow has no interest or intention of purchasing Decagon." Business Insider updated its story to say ServiceNow is no longer in talks.
- Business Insider says Decagon could raise a new funding round if no deal happens. Decagon did not comment.
- PYMNTS notes Decagon raised $250 million at a $4.5 billion valuation in January.
- **Our view:** Salesforce bought Fin last month. A sale of Decagon would leave buyers with fewer large independent AI customer-service vendors.
- **Watch:** a named buyer, a signed deal or a new funding round.

The personal-agent standard goes public

- Sierra and Meta launched the Personal Agent Protocol on 6 October. On 14 October it became a public GitHub project, labelled draft 0.1. The draft says "any part of it can change".
- The draft makes every message say whether a person or an AI agent wrote it. A personal agent can ask for a person; if no one is available, the request goes back to idle.
- Lorikeet switched on support on 12 October. It says ChatGPT "cannot speak" the protocol yet.
- Zendesk announced an Open Service Directory on 13 October, a public list of verified support contacts for AI assistants. Zendesk says it will adopt the new protocols.
- Parloa said on 15 October it is building middleware for personal agents. Wonderful opened its own agent-access product to design partners on 12 October.
- The design-partner list names Genesys, NiCE, Sierra and Zendesk among technology providers. Salesforce and Microsoft are not on it.
- **Our view:** the draft writes a request for a human into the standard. Contact centres should expect personal agents that ask for a person on purpose.
- **Watch:** a tagged release or reference implementation, and whether Salesforce joins.

xAI says AI handles most of Starlink's calls

- xAI said on 14 October that Starlink's call centres answer 20,000 customer calls a day with its Grok Voice model. "Roughly 70% are resolved with no human in the loop."
- xAI says one agent verifies customers, troubleshoots hardware, issues credits and ships replacement equipment. The model costs $0.08 a minute, or $4.80 an hour.
- The figure comes from the supplier, not an independent source. xAI does not define "resolved" or give a repeat-call rate.
- **Our view:** this is a claimed figure for a whole support line, not a pilot. A per-minute price adds one more unit beside seats, credits and resolutions.

Fin settles on 76%

- Last week a Fin learning page said its average resolution rate across all customers was 67%, with early-stage teams at 76%.
- The same page now says: “Fin’s average resolution rate across all customers is 76%, and it improves approximately 1% per month.” Its dates still read 9 October.
- The page now says Fin serves 12,000+ businesses and resolves 2 million conversations a week, up from 8,000+ businesses and 1 million.
- **Our view:** the lower figure was removed, not explained. We cite 76% as Fin’s own claim.

Scheduling: no automatic response to live demand yet

- Lorikeet’s own comparison of scheduling tools, checked 8 October, says its Workforce Manager is “New in October 2026; intraday is next, not live at launch”.
- Its launch post still says the tool “will manage the day” by 9 October. We found no later dated post, release note, price or named customer.
- Microsoft added contact-centre workforce management items to its public roadmap on 16 October, the first we have seen there. Two intraday features due in October alert supervisors and report staffing against forecast.
- Cisne joined Five9’s marketplace on 13 October. Cisne says its staffing plans model the contacts that bots handle, but its intraday tool is “recommending schedule adjustments”.
- Aspect says its February release included rule-based automatic schedule edits. They apply when “predefined workforce conditions are met”. Automatic intraday correction is marked “Coming Soon”.
- Last week we described Aspect’s software as recommending changes, and called Lorikeet’s offer the first in our coverage to change the live schedule by itself.
- Both statements hold only for changes driven by live demand, not for Aspect’s rule-based edits.
- **Our view:** software that changes the schedule by itself when live demand shifts is still a promise among the vendors we track. Edits triggered by customer-set rules already exist.
- **Watch:** Microsoft’s October intraday features, and dated proof that Lorikeet’s live mode has shipped.

Agent assist turns into agents that act

- Cresta launched Deputy Agent on 13 October. Cresta says it keeps working on refunds, disputes and insurance-claim appeals for days or weeks after the call.
- It can start from Cresta’s live guidance for human agents, take handoffs from Cresta’s AI agent, or run alone. Cresta says business rules decide which actions wait for review.

- Cresta gave no price or availability date. Its two named customers speak of “an opportunity” and excitement, not results.
- Five9 regrouped its product menu in the week of its 12 and 13 October customer event, its website shows. AI agents and live help for human agents now sit side by side.
- Quality scoring, coaching and scheduling now sit together under “Optimize”. Five9 issued no release about the change.
- A Five9-commissioned survey of 3,000 consumers, fielded in April, says trust in AI rises from 26% to 55% when a human option is reachable.
- **Our view:** both vendors now present help for human agents and autonomous AI as parts of one product.

Quality and analytics

- CallMiner released deeper analytics and a redesigned real-time supervisor view on 14 October. British Gas says tasks “that previously took hours of manual analysis can now be completed in minutes.”
- Verint says IDC named it a Leader in conversation analytics (14 October). Its release names no Calabrio product.
- Microsoft’s roadmap now lists real-time coaching during live conversations by its quality agent, marked as launched.
- FourNet, a UK contact-centre integrator, bought SVL, a firm with recording and workforce management skills, on 15 October. Terms were not disclosed.

Workplace AI rules

- **California:** Zaller Law wrote on 17 October that the emotion-AI ban comes up in “sales and customer service environments that record calls or video meetings, then grade the representative.”
- It says scoring a customer’s sentiment “is a different question” from scoring the employee’s tone. “The employee-facing piece is what triggers AB 1883.”
- It advises employers to list features, not just products, and to require vendor notice before new analytics are switched on. The ban starts on 1 January 2027.
- CDF Labor Law advises employers to get vendors’ written confirmation and to disable or replace such features before year-end.
- We found no contact-centre or WEM vendor renaming, limiting or switching off an emotion, sentiment or wellbeing feature for California.
- **UK:** techUK, the technology trade body, said on 13 October that the proposed monitoring definition captures “scheduling, workforce planning”. It asks for non-statutory guidance, not new duties.

- The UK government has not published a response to its consultation, which closed on 30 September.
- **Colorado:** the revised draft rules are unchanged. Comments close and the hearing takes place on 26 October.
- **Our view:** in California, quality and coaching tools that score both the customer's sentiment and the agent's tone are exposed. Lawyers' advice points to pressure through buyers' contracts first.

Outsourcers: pressure and growth side by side

- Foundever, an outsourcer with about 130,000 staff, named Pierre Barrial, formerly chief executive of IDEMIA, as chief executive on 13 October. He says the company can "accelerate AI deployment".
- In August Foundever completed a recapitalisation that cut nearly $900 million of debt, Outsource Accelerator reported at the time.
- Conduent's lenders extended part of its credit line, due on 15 October, to 30 October while they finalise a refinancing, it filed. The filing does not mention AI.
- TELUS Digital became an implementation partner for Parloa's AI agents on 14 October. Clients contract with Parloa for the platform and with TELUS Digital for services.
- **Against:** TP, formerly Teleperformance, is opening its 29th Philippine site, which TP expects to create more than 1,000 jobs, Outsource Accelerator reports.
- Indian outsourcer Fusion CX's ₹702 crore share sale was 4.68 times subscribed. Its total income grew 37% in the year to March 2026.
- Jamaica's outsourcing association says jobs fell from 60,000 to about 40,000. Its president rejects AI as the main cause, pointing to electricity costs and weak promotion.
- Workday's chief executive, Aneel Bhusri, said on 15 October that outsourced "low-level automation jobs" are where he worries most about AI replacement.
- **Our view:** the strain on outsourcers is uneven. Indebted firms are restructuring around AI while others still add seats and raise money.

Pricing: no move back to seats

- No tracked vendor moved from per-resolution pricing back to per-seat pricing. We re-read ten public price pages on 18 October.
- The only change: Salesforce added euro, pound and krona prices to its seat-priced contact centre. Its per-conversation price for customer-facing AI is unchanged.
- Microsoft will sell Microsoft 365 Copilot without a Microsoft 365 base licence from 1 December, at the same per-user price.

- Microsoft also moved default usage billing for new Copilot Business licences to 1 December. It will not apply at first in 11 countries, including France and Germany.

Other company developments

- **Salesforce:** Tottenham Hotspur's Agentforce assistant resolves 20% of interactions alone, Salesforce reports. When it cannot resolve a question, it hands the conversation to the club's human support team.
- **AlloBrain:** this Paris contact-centre AI vendor raised $7 million led by Varsity, Startup.eu reports. It sells live assist, quality analysis and AI agents in one platform.
- **NiCE:** has not announced its third-quarter results date (investor page read 18 October). The reported Actimize sale talks remain unconfirmed.
- **Five9:** has not announced its third-quarter results date.

What to watch

- **20 to 22 October:** Zoom's Zoomtopia event; CallMiner's LISTEN West conference on 20 and 21 October.
- **26 October:** Colorado's comment deadline and hearing on the automated-decision rules.
- **28 October:** Microsoft's quarterly results.
- **30 October:** Conduent's extended credit line falls due unless refinanced.
- **November:** Salesforce's Casey fixes and its Australia and New Zealand launch.
- **16 November:** TTEC's loan margin rises unless amended; Microsoft's sales agent starts using credits.
- **1 December:** Microsoft 365 Copilot goes on sale without a base licence.
- **1 January 2027:** California's emotion-AI ban and Colorado's rules take effect.
- **Open:** Decagon's next step; NiCE and Five9 results dates; a Personal Agent Protocol release; Lorikeet's live scheduling mode; Automation Anywhere closing its Boost.ai deal.
- **New companies surfaced, not yet tracked:** AlloBrain (assist, quality and AI agents), Wonderful (AI agents), xAI's Grok Voice (voice AI), Fusion CX (outsourcer with its own quality and scheduling tools) and FourNet (integrator).

Correction: our 10 October edition listed an Observe.AI customer event on 13 and 14 October. Observe.AI's own event page dates its TransformX conference to 24 to 26 February 2026.

Evidence for the next prediction check, due next week: Salesforce's European launch and Starlink's claimed resolution rate bear on the predictions about one engine and about job losses. Intraday scheduling still stops at alerts and recommendations.

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